Women at IISER Kolkata and across the IISERs

As part of our inclusivity work we studied who is enrolled and who teaches at the IISERs, using only public data (NIRF submissions, 2019 to 2026, and the national AISHE survey). We want to share the results with you before they are published in a spirit of shared interest. We are not criticising any group or person.

The Findings in Brief

- **Students.** Women are 27.2% of undergraduate five-year (BS-MS) students at IISER Kolkata (286 of 1,050; NIRF 2026), up from 24.2% in 2017-18. The seven IISERs together are about 40% women, and TVM and Tirupati are about 52%. Kolkata has the fewest women of the seven, and its share is close to the 26.5% reported for all Institutes of National Importance together.
- **Faculty.** Women are 14.4% of regular faculty at IISER Kolkata (18 of 125), and the share has stayed between 13.8% and 14.4% in all eight lists since 2019. The seven IISERs together are 18.8%. At the other six IISERs the share of women is higher among more recently appointed faculty. At Kolkata this is not clearly so (8 of 59 who joined from 2013, against 104 of 476 elsewhere). The groups are small.
- **The PhD stage nationally.** In 2023-24, SC students were 13.7% of master's and 10.0% of PhD students in India, and ST students 6.2% and 4.1%. Women were 51.3% of undergraduates but 39.8% of PhD students in West Bengal. Public data do not allow us to see this for IISER Kolkata itself.
- **Comparing IISER Kolkata with the national average:** Women are 49.5% of UG students and 50.1% of Ph.D. students nationally. At IISER Kolkata, this percentage is 27.2% and 33% (postgraduates), respectively.

The average of all INIs (Institutes of National Importance) stands at 34.6% of female Ph.D. students. The INIs are anyways 14.0 points below all universities (the gap was 11.8 in 2019-20). In Institutes of National Importance taken together, women are far lesser than the national average at every level: 26.5% at UG, 30.9% at PG and 34.6% at Ph.D. in 2023-24. Interestingly, IISER Kolkata stands below the average of INIs as well.

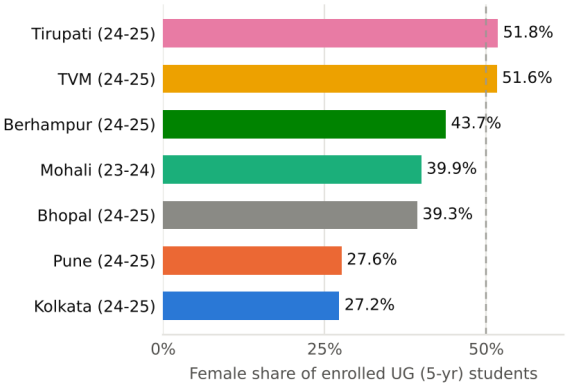


Figure 1. Women among UG five-year students, latest year (NIRF).

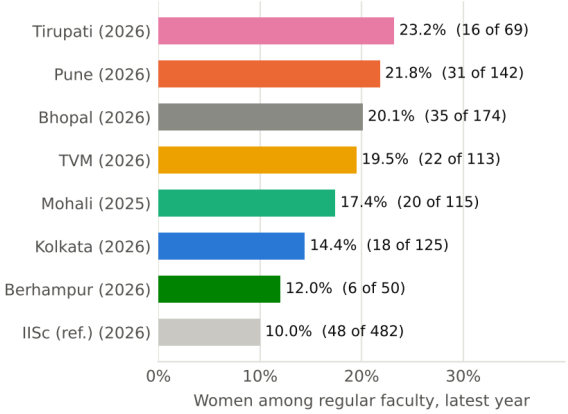


Figure 2. Women among regular faculty, latest list (NIRF).

Sources: NIRF "Overall" data submissions (nirfindia.org), 2019 to 2026; All India Survey on Higher Education (aishe.gov.in), 2019-20 to 2023-24. Full reports available and attached.